

Economics

Middletown High School | Grade 12, Fall Semester 2026

Teacher: Mr. T. Vandermeer
Room: 226
Email: tvandermeer@middletownhigh.edu

Course Description

An introduction to microeconomics and macroeconomics. Students use diagrams and real data to explain prices, unemployment, inflation and policy choices.

Course Units

Weeks 1 to 3	Unit 1: Supply and Demand The law of demand says that as price rises, quantity demanded falls. Equilibrium is where supply meets demand. A shift of the whole curve comes from non price factors such as income or tastes.
Weeks 4 to 6	Unit 2: Market Structures Perfect competition, monopoly, oligopoly and monopolistic competition, and why market power changes price.
Weeks 7 to 10	Unit 3: Macroeconomic Indicators GDP, inflation measured by the consumer price index, and unemployment, with the limits of each measure.
Weeks 11 to 13	Unit 4: Fiscal and Monetary Policy Fiscal policy is government spending and taxation. Monetary policy is the central bank setting interest rates and the money supply. Higher interest rates usually reduce inflation.
Weeks 14 to 16	Unit 5: International Trade Comparative advantage, tariffs and quotas, and exchange rates.

Key Dates This Semester

Oct 5	Market Analysis Assignment due
Oct 22	Mid-Term Exam, covers Units 1 to 3
Nov 18	Policy Debate
Dec 16	Final Exam

School wide dates

Sep 8	First day of classes
Oct 19 to Oct 23	Mid-term examination week
Nov 6	Parent teacher conferences
Nov 25 to Nov 27	Thanksgiving break, no classes
Dec 14 to Dec 18	Final examination week

Materials

Notebook, ruler for diagrams, calculator, access to current news sources.

Grading Policy

20 percent	Assignments
10 percent	Policy debate
15 percent	Quizzes
35 percent	Unit tests
20 percent	Final exam

A = 90 to 100 percent, B = 80 to 89, C = 70 to 79, D = 60 to 69, F = 59 and below.

Late and Make-Up Work

Work handed in late without an excused absence receives a maximum of 50 percent credit. With an excused absence,

work is due within one week of returning. It is the student's responsibility to ask what was missed. Make-up tests are held on Thursdays after school and must be booked at least one day ahead.

Academic Honesty

All work submitted must be your own. Copying another student's work, or submitting text or code generated by someone or something else as your own, is treated as academic dishonesty and results in a zero for that assignment and a call home.

Extra Help

Extra help is available Tuesdays and Thursdays, 3:15 to 4:00 pm, in the room listed above.